

Chapter 76-1

This sudden turn of events startled both Liang Shi and Gu Zhaoyuan at the same time.

"Father." Gu Zhaoyuan stepped forward and held him down. "Calm down a little."

But Dean Gu kept shouting: "Lunatic! Lunatic! Crazy woman!"

Liang Shi stood up and took half a step back, momentarily unsure whether she should continue asking questions.

After a moment of hesitation, she continued to ask: "Dean, you know Yang Jiani, don't you? Did she do something to Gu Xingyue?"

Upon hearing the name Gu Xingyue, Gu Zhaoyuan was stunned, and his grip loosened.

Dean Gu suddenly broke free and ran madly toward Liang Shi, directly grabbing her by the collar. "You lunatic!"

Liang Shi felt somewhat uncomfortable from being choked, her brows furrowed tightly, but she didn't forcefully break free, afraid of hurting Dean Gu.

Dean Gu's mouth kept repeating the same few phrases.

Lunatic, crazy woman, get out.

Gu Zhaoyuan was also afraid that continuing to talk would further agitate his father. After restraining his father, he asked Liang Shi to step outside first.

The deep corridor was empty and silent, with no one passing through.

The nursing home was quiet at night; only a few birds occasionally flew overhead in circles, and before long, even the birds disappeared.

More than ten minutes later, Gu Zhaoyuan finally emerged from the room drenched in sweat. He first said to Liang Shi in a low voice: "I'm sorry, my father didn't hurt you, did he?"

"No," Liang Shi replied.

Gu Zhaoyuan had given Dean Gu a sedative, and Dean Gu had fallen into a deep sleep.

Liang Shi had just learned that Dean Gu would go mad from time to time, but there were occasionally moments during each day when he was lucid—it all depended on luck.

Actually, Liang Shi was quite lucky today. When she arrived, Dean Gu happened to be lucid and was even reading a book.

It was only because Liang Shi mentioned Yang Jiani that he became agitated and went mad again.

After apologizing to her, Gu Zhaoyuan asked who Yang Jiani was and why she had mentioned his younger sister.

Liang Shi only said vaguely: "Perhaps your sister hasn't passed away, but I can't tell you anything more than that."

She only promised Gu Zhaoyuan that if she found Gu Xingyue one day, and if Gu Xingyue was willing, she would bring Gu Xingyue to meet him.

The amount of information was overwhelming, leaving Gu Zhaoyuan at a loss for words.

He asked three times in a row: "My sister is still alive?"

Liang Shi nodded. "She should still be alive."

She didn't give a completely certain answer.

But for Gu Zhaoyuan, this was already tremendously good news. However, after the initial excitement passed, Gu Zhaoyuan calmed down and thought: "So my father decided to rebuild the orphanage because of what happened to my sister?"

"That possibility can't be ruled out," Liang Shi said. "But for the specifics, you'd have to ask your father."

Gu Zhaoyuan smiled bitterly. "You've also seen his current condition. I just hope he can spend his remaining years in peace."

Liang Shi nodded. "Then I've disturbed you this time. I'm sorry."

"It's fine. I'm truly very grateful for the information you've provided." Gu Zhaoyuan said sincerely: "Miss Liang, you must find my sister. Even if we don't meet, just let me know that she's still alive and well in this world."

Liang Shi nodded. "I'll do my best."

Afterward, the two of them discussed some matters about establishing an orphanage. In this regard, Gu Zhaoyuan was an expert, so Liang Shi simply agreed with what he said.

Under the bright moon and sparse stars¹, Liang Shi drove away from the nursing home.

After Gu Zhaoyuan watched her car leave, he hurried back to his father's room.

He saw his father lying on the bed, hands tightly gripping the bedsheets, his face aged.

Even in his sleep, he was softly murmuring: "Xingyue."

Gu Zhaoyuan stood at the doorway, sighing helplessly.

After a while, he bent down to pick up the torn books scattered on the floor.

1. 夜朗星稀 (yè lǎng xīng xī) - A classical Chinese expression describing a night scene where the moon is bright and the stars are few. It's a poetic way to describe a clear, moonlit night. ↩